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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **IMAX is in the** early stages of exploring a sale and has approached entertainment companies as potential buyers as premium theatrical experiences grow faster than the overall box office. **B1**

◆ **Walmart reported** strong sales growth for the most-recent quarter and said rising fuel prices could draw more cash-strapped low-income shoppers. **B1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rose, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq advancing 0.2% and 0.1%, respectively, and the Dow gaining 0.6% to a record. **B9**

◆ **Business activity in the** U.S. grew at a steady pace in May, while slowing in Europe and Asia as energy costs have risen. **A2**

◆ **Meta Platforms and** other social-media providers reached a settlement with a Kentucky school district over accusations that they intended to addict young people. **B1**

◆ **“The Breakfast Club,”** the influential morning radio show co-hosted by Charlamagne tha God, will be streamed live on Netflix, making it the service’s first daily live program. **B1**

◆ **Exxon Mobil struck back** at two proxy advisory firms opposed to the company’s plan to move its legal home to Texas from New Jersey. **B5**

◆ **Deere posted** higher fiscal-second-quarter sales as growth in its construction-equipment business helped offset weakness in its production agriculture segment. **B2**

◆ **A drug developed by** Eli Lilly delivered clinically meaningful weight loss in a phase-3 clinical trial. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **Senate Republicans** broke with Trump over his administration’s plan to create a \$1.8 billion settlement fund to pay people who claim political persecution, with widespread opposition forcing party leaders to abandon votes on immigration-enforcement funding. **A1**

◆ **House Republican leaders** yanked a planned vote to restrict Trump’s ability to conduct military strikes against Iran after it became clear the resolution would likely pass. **A1**

◆ **Trump postponed** the signing of an executive order that would have given the government more oversight over the AI industry. **A1**

◆ **The Democratic National Committee** released an incomplete and critically annotated report detailing the party’s mistakes in the 2024 election. **A6**

◆ **A federal judge** in Chicago dismissed all charges against a group of anti-ICE demonstrators, saying prosecutors acted improperly when presenting the case to a grand jury. **A3**

◆ **The Trump administration** will award \$2 billion in grants to nine quantum-computing companies in deals that include U.S. government equity stakes. **A4**

◆ **A Virginia judge** threw out all criminal charges against a former elementary school assistant principal who was accused of negligence after a 6-year-old student shot a teacher in 2023. **A3**

◆ **Four new studies** suggest GLP-1 weight-loss and diabetes drugs are linked to better outcomes for cancer patients. **A3**

◆ **Died: Kyle Busch**, 41, superstar of the Nascar circuit. **A2**

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At Arlington, a Head Start on Memorial Day



SOLEMN RESPECTS: First Sgt. Kosovare Fain carried her 4-year-old daughter, Reagan, as she and fellow soldiers of the Army 3d Infantry Regiment, or Old Guard, marked graves with flags Thursday at Arlington National Cemetery in Virginia.

Musk Set to Keep Firm Control Of SpaceX After It Goes Public

Supervoting shares, Texas law make it hard to fire CEO and limit investor suits

By BECKY PETERSON

Elon Musk holds so much power at SpaceX that it is nearly impossible to fire him, or make other significant corporate changes without his support.

That isn’t going to change for investors in the company’s

initial public offering.

Musk will have a near-unprecedented level of control at a public company of its valuation, which is expected to reach at least \$1.5 trillion.

The SpaceX founder, who serves as chairman, chief executive and chief technical officer, controls about 85% of the voting power at the satellite builder, rocket-launch provider and artificial-intelligence developer.

The structure remedies some of the frustrations that Musk has faced running Tesla.

In its 16 years on Wall Street, the electric-vehicle maker has been a lightning rod for shareholder lawsuits and activist calls for Musk’s dismissal. The executive has complained, at times, that he dislikes running a public company.

SpaceX’s ownership structure gives different rights to various groups of investors. Individual investors will be able to buy class A shares, which have just one vote apiece. Meanwhile Class B shares carry 10 votes for each share owned, according to a securi-

ties filing Wednesday. Musk holds around 94% of Class B shares.

Google and Facebook both put in place supervoting shares before they went public, granting their founders a level of outsized control. In both cases, shareholders had other ways to take action: They could sue in state court in Delaware, where the companies were incorporated, or sell their shares.

In the case of SpaceX, however, there are restrictions that

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President Delays Order on AI, Fearing U.S. Would Fall Behind

By AMRITH RAMKUMAR

WASHINGTON—President Trump postponed the signing of an executive order that would have given the government more oversight over the artificial-intelligence industry, saying he didn’t want to take any action that would slow down the U.S. in the AI race.

Hours before a scheduled signing event Thursday that was set to include industry executives, Trump said in the Oval Office that the order would have asked AI companies to preview models with

the federal government. Such a move would set back the U.S. in its competition with China, which AI analysts say the U.S. is winning, he said.

“I really thought that could have been a blocker, and I want to make sure it’s not,” he said, citing the number of jobs the technology is creating. “I don’t want to do anything that will get in the way of that lead.”

The move is the latest example of the White House being divided on AI policy. Administration officials have been trying to bolster cybersecurity following the release of

powerful models including Anthropic’s Mythos, but some AI advisers fear the steps could slow down the development of new AI tools, creating two camps within the administration that are quarreling over the tech agenda.

Trump’s move came hours after California Gov. Gavin Newsom, a Democrat, issued an executive order mandating that the state prepare policies to address the job losses and

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◆ **U.S. invests in quantum-computing firms.....** **A4**

U.S.-China Diplomacy Is Alive With ‘The Sound of Music’

* * *

‘Edelweiss’ and ‘Do Re Mi’ are standards in schools, karaoke bars and at state banquets

By HANNAH MIAO

BEIJING—At a state banquet hosted by Xi Jinping last week, President Trump was treated to a Chinese military band playing one of his favorite songs, “Y.M.C.A.” Also on the set list was another familiar melody: “Edelweiss.”

Trump, more of a “Phantom of the Opera” fan, didn’t react in any discernible way.

The Rodgers and Hammerstein show tune, written in the style of an Austrian folk song, may not be a cornerstone of the Mar-a-Lago soundtrack, but it’s a mainstay of U.S.-China diplomacy. Songs from “The Sound

of Music” have long been used to welcome American dignitaries to China.

When Vice President Walter Mondale visited in 1979, he quipped that he heard “two Chinese classics, ‘Jingle Bells’ and ‘Do Re Mi.’” In 2002, President George W. Bush was greeted at the Great Wall by a gaggle of children singing “Edelweiss.” A singer from the Chinese military serenaded then-Defense Secretary Jim Mattis with the song during his 2018 trip.

The musical’s tunes are among the most widely known English-language songs in China, embraced as a wholesome and earnest tale about

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INSIDE



UNC ATHLETICS

JASON GAY
College lacrosse has its Caitlin Clark—or maybe its Michael Jordan—in this scoring dynamo. **A16**

MANSION
The film festival draws celebrities, but home buyers want Cannes’ quieter side. **M1**

Israeli Forces Stalk Oct. 7 Attackers

Militants who videotaped their exploits that day have been identified and killed

By DOV LIEBER

Hours after militants crossed from Gaza into Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, a video surfaced of an Israeli woman screaming, “Don’t kill me,” as she was hauled away on a motorcycle, sandwiched between two kidnappers.

The young woman, who was among those assaulted at a desert music festival, reached helplessly for her boyfriend, who was restrained by Gazan men. The video was one of the first of many terrifying images from the attack by Hamas on southern Israel that ended with 1,200 dead and around

250 hostages taken, including the couple.

Noa Argamani, who was seized less than a week before her 26th birthday, spent 245 days captive in Gaza. After she was freed in a rescue mission, two men seen in the video holding back Argamani’s boyfriend were tracked down by Israeli intelligence officials and killed in separate airstrikes.

The men were crossed off a list of thousands of names kept by an Israeli task force created for one job—to kill or capture all who planned or joined in the Oct. 7 attack, said current and for-

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